



THE REPUBLIC OF LIBERIA
LIBERIA MARITIME AUTHORITY

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Marine Security Advisory: 05/2014

(This Advisory supersedes Marine Security Advisory 1/2014)

Subject: Guidelines for protection against armed robbery and piracy in the Gulf of Guinea region and Reporting to the Maritime Trade Information Sharing Centre Gulf Guinea (MTISC – GoG)

Ref: (a) Maritime Security Chart Q6114
(b) Marine Security Advisory 1-2013
(c) BMP4

Dear Shipowners/Operators/Masters:

In response to incidents of armed robbery and piracy attacks that have occurred in and around the Gulf of Guinea, the Liberian Administration has revised the setting of MANDATORY SECURITY LEVEL EQUIVALENT TO LEVEL II for all Liberian flagged vessels when operating in or transiting the Gulf of Guinea and adjacent waters, effective immediately.

The Administrator is bringing its previously defined Gulf of Guinea region in line with the recently established voluntary reporting area (VRA) depicted within the UK Hydrographic Office's Maritime Security Chart for West Africa (see attached).

Mandatory Security Level equivalent to Level II shall be set when operating in or transiting West African waters, defined by the following boundaries:

FROM:	TO:
(Southernmost Tip of Cape Blanc*)	
*20-45N 17-00W	20-45N 20-00W
20-45N 20-00W	10-00N 20-00W
10-00N 20-00W	00-00N/S 09-45W
00-00N/S 09-45W	00-00N/S 00-00E/W
00-00N/S 00-00E/W	10-00S 10-00E
10-00S 10-00E	17-15S 10-00E
17-15S 10-00E	**17-15S 11-45E
	(Angola / Namibia border**)

Security Level equivalent to Level II is required to ensure higher vigilance and tighter controls to protect against possible acts of piracy, illegal boarding and stowaways.

Upon change of Security Level Masters should report to the Administration via email to security@liscr.com.

Reporting to Maritime Trade Information Sharing Centre for the Gulf of Guinea (MTISC-GoG)

The recently established MTISC-GoG is the first regional maritime information sharing center within the Gulf of Guinea. The Center is fully engaged with regional States and supported by international partners and maritime industry stakeholders. The Liberian Maritime Authority is strong supporter and has seconded watch standers to the Center.

Shipowners/Operators/Masters of Liberian flagged vessels are strongly encouraged to participate in the MTISC Voluntary Reporting Scheme to improve regional domain awareness and information sharing and allow relevant authorities to be informed of an incident in a timely manner.

Masters of vessels are advised to provide an “Initial Report” to MTISC-GoG when entering the affected area defined above or leaving a port within this area and report daily while operating within the established area; and to submit a final report when leaving the defined area. Report formats are attached.

The Center will provide advice and guidance on the maritime security situation and on mitigating the risk of armed robbery or other unlawful activities.

Through 24-hour manned monitoring of reporting vessels, the MTISC-GoG will share updates and guidance on security risks and incidents with the shipping industry and merchant vessels directly. In the event of a security incident **MTISC-GoG** will be able to warn vessels in the vicinity either directly by using a satellite telephone or making use of **Nav Warnings**. **MITSC-GoG** will be able to liaise directly with the affected vessel’s Master and provide guidance. **MTISC-GoG** will have no operational control of naval vessels, but can provide information to National maritime operational centers in the region.

In addition, the Administration strongly recommends owners, operators and Master’s ensure full consideration is given to interim Guidelines developed by BIMCO, ICS, INTERCARGO and INTERTANKO, and supported by the NATO Shipping Centre. Although piracy in the Gulf of Guinea is different from Somali piracy, large sections of the current Best Management Practices will also be applicable to the pirate attacks on vessels operating in the Gulf of Guinea.

The interim Guidelines aim to bridge the gap between the advice found in BMP4 and the prevailing situation in the Gulf of Guinea. Consequently, the Interim Gulf of Guinea guidelines should be read in conjunction with BMP4 as they will make reference to BMP4 when relevant.

Guidelines: http://www.liscr.com/liscr/Portals/0/InterimGuidelinesAgainstPiracy_GulfOfGuinea.pdf

BMP4: <http://www.liscr.com/liscr/Portals/0/BMP4.pdf>

Action:

Prior to a vessel entering the affected area, CSO’s should review the Ship Security Assessment (SSA) and ensure full consideration is given to the interim Guidelines in conjunction with BMP4, in accordance with the Administrations guidelines contained in MARINE SECURITY ADVISORY: 1-2013.

For more information please contact the Security Department at telephone + 1 703 790 3434 email security@liscr.com

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MTISC GoG STANDARDIZED REPORTING FORMATS

CONTACT	
Phone 1.	+233 (0)302 718 227
Phone 2.	+233 (0)260 561 633
Phone 3.	+233 (0)248 060 789
Email	info@mtiscgog.org
Website	www.mtisc-gog.org

Initial Report

(To be submitted upon entering the VRA to register with MTISC-GoG)

MTISC-GoG Initial Report		
1	Ship name	
2	Flag	
3	IMO Number	
4	INMARSAT Telephone Number	
5	MMSI	
6	Time of report in UTC	
7	Ship position	
8	Course	
9	Passage speed	
10	Freeboard	
11	Cargo	
12	Destination and Estimated Time of Arrival	
13	Name and contact details of Company Security Officer	
14	Nationality of Master and Crew	
15	Armed / unarmed security team embarked?	

Daily Report

at 0800 UTC

(All reports should be in UTC)

MTISC-GoG Daily Report		
1	Ship name	
2	Ship call sign & IMO Number	
3	Time of report in UTC	
4	Ship Position	
5	Ship Course and Speed	
6	Sightings of Illegal Unlawful Unregulated (IUU) fishing or other assessed illegal activity. Time, position, brief description of craft and activity witnessed.	

Final Report
(Upon departure from the VRA)

MTISC-GoG Final Report		
1	Ship name	
2	Ship call sign & IMO Number	
3	Time of report in UTC	
4	Port or position when leaving the GoG VRA	

Incident Report

MTISC-GoG By Exception Report		
<i>All incidents of piracy, armed robbery, suspicious sightings, or illegal activity in West African waters are to be immediately reported to the MTISC-GoG (with a copy to security@liscr.com) using the format below.</i> <i>After reporting to the MTISC-GoG, the Administrator is to be informed of the incident by submitting form PIRACY and ARMED ROBBERY and the IMB PRC is to be notified by submitting a Piracy & Armed Robbery Report.</i>		
1	Own Ship Name	
2	Own Ship call sign & IMO Number	
3	Time of report in UTC	
4	Own Ship Position	
5	Own Ship Course and Speed	
6	Sightings of Illegal Unlawful Unregulated (IUU) fishing or other assessed illegal activity. Time, position, brief description of craft and activity witnessed.	

